TROOP 157 WEBSITE PROJECT

Contributor Starter Guide

Learn the tools. Practice safely. Make your first contribution.

Project introduction

The GitHub repository below currently contains a basic website template. It is not a finished troop website. The team will use it as a starting point, replace the placeholders, test each other's work, and improve it over time.

Open the Troop 157 website repository
https://github.com/shivenp14/troop_157_website

Your learning path

1	**Understand**	Learn what the files do and how the team works.
2	**Practice**	Practice Git and beginner web skills away from the real project.
3	**Contribute**	Make one small change on a branch and open a pull request.
4	**Review**	Check a teammate's work for clarity, safety, and correctness.

You do not need to know everything before helping. Good contributors ask questions, make small changes, and review their work carefully.

1. How The Website Works

The project uses plain HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, with Vite as the local development tool.

Technology	How we use it
HTML The structure and words on a webpage.	Start here: headings, paragraphs, links, event cards, and announcements.
CSS The visual style of a webpage.	Learn next: colors, spacing, borders, text size, and simple layouts.
JavaScript Behavior and interactivity.	Learn later: the mobile menu and eventually data-driven features.
Vite A tool that runs the site on your laptop.	Use the commands in this guide. You do not need to learn Vite programming.

Important project files

`index.html`	Home page
`events.html`	Events list and placeholder calendar
`announcements.html`	Troop announcements
`contact.html`	Approved public contact information
`styles/main.css`	Shared visual styles
`scripts/main.js`	Small shared JavaScript behaviors

Start small

Most first contributions should change HTML text or copy an existing HTML pattern. More experienced or interested scouts can try small CSS changes. Shared JavaScript should be changed only with guidance at first.

Public safety rules

- Do not publish youth last names, personal email addresses, phone numbers, schools, or home addresses.
- Use only photos and documents approved for public use.
- Ask the project lead before changing navigation, shared styles, or JavaScript.

2. The Git And GitHub Workflow

Git saves the history of the project. GitHub lets the team share, review, and approve changes.

1	**Update main**	Start from the newest approved version.
2	**Create a branch**	Give one task its own safe workspace.
3	**Make a small change**	Complete only the assigned task.
4	**Commit**	Save a checkpoint with a clear message.
5	**Push**	Upload the branch to GitHub.
6	**Open a pull request**	Ask the team to review your change.
7	**Review and improve**	Answer comments and fix problems.
8	**Merge**	The project lead accepts the approved change.

Words to remember

Repository	The project folder and its saved history.
Branch	A separate workspace for one change.
Commit	A saved checkpoint with a short description.
Pull request	A request for teammates to review and merge your branch.

Team rule

Do not push directly to main. Work on a branch, open a pull request, and wait for review. A pull request is not a test you pass or fail - it is where the team improves the work together.

3. Practice Before You Contribute

Use these two learning websites to practice without worrying about breaking the troop website.

Git practice: Git Mastery

Git Mastery teaches Git commands and ideas through an interactive game and safe sandbox. Begin with the beginner learning path. Focus on repositories, commits, branches, and merging before trying advanced topics.

Open Git Mastery
https://gitmastery.me/

Programming practice: Codecademy - Learn HTML

Codecademy's beginner HTML course has no prerequisites. It teaches the structure of webpages using elements and tags, then introduces tables, forms, and semantic HTML. Start with the Elements and Structure lessons.

Open Codecademy: Learn HTML
https://www.codecademy.com/learn/learn-html

Recommended learning order

Stage	Focus	You are ready when...
1	HTML	You can change headings, paragraphs, links, and copy an existing event card.
2	CSS	You can safely adjust a color, border, spacing value, or text size.
3	JavaScript	You understand variables, functions, and click events. This stage can wait.

Practice goals before your first pull request

- Complete several beginner Git Mastery exercises involving commits and branches.
- Complete Codecademy's Elements and Structure HTML lessons.
- Explain, in your own words, what a branch and pull request are.
- Ask for help when a command or error message does not make sense.

4. Laptop Prerequisites

Complete this setup before the first coding session if possible.

Install or prepare	Why it is needed
GitHub account	Access the repository, branches, and pull requests.
Repository access	The project lead must invite your GitHub account as a collaborator.
GitHub Desktop	Clone the project and use Git visually while learning the workflow.
Visual Studio Code	Open and edit the HTML, CSS, and JavaScript files.
Node.js LTS	Provides npm, which installs Vite and runs the website locally.
Modern browser	View and test the local website. Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari works.
Internet connection	Needed for the first npm install and for GitHub syncing.

Official download links

GitHub Desktop

https://desktop.github.com/download/

Visual Studio Code

https://code.visualstudio.com/Download

Node.js LTS

https://nodejs.org/en/download

5. Run The Website On Your Laptop

These commands start the current template so you can see changes while you work.

First time only

Clone the repository with GitHub Desktop, open the project folder in Visual Studio Code, then open VS Code's terminal and run:

```
npm install
```

This downloads the development tools listed in package.json. You usually run it once, or again after dependencies change.

Every work session

```
npm run dev
```

Vite will print a local address, usually:

```
http://localhost:5173
```

Open that address in your browser. Keep the terminal running while you work. Press Ctrl+C in the terminal when you are finished.

Before opening a pull request

```
npm run check:js
npm run build
```

If a command reports an error, stop and ask for help. Do not hide the error or commit generated node_modules or dist folders.

Your first contribution

1	Choose one small assigned task.
2	Create a branch before editing.
3	Change only the assigned HTML content or copied pattern.
4	Run the site and inspect the changed page.
5	Commit with a short, specific message.
6	Push the branch and open a pull request.
7	Explain what changed and request review.

When you get stuck

Copy the full error message, write down what you were trying to do, and ask a teammate or the project lead. Getting stuck is a normal part of programming; explaining the problem clearly is a valuable skill.